Pharmacy Benefits and Formulary Guide

Synthetic training document for an educational RAG project. This is not an official Aetna policy or plan document.

Pharmacy Benefit Overview

Prescription drug benefits may use a formulary that groups medications into tiers. Member cost can vary by medication tier, pharmacy network, quantity, and plan design.

Utilization Management

Some medications may require prior authorization, step therapy, or quantity limits. Specialty medications may require designated pharmacy channels or additional clinical review.

Step Therapy

Step therapy requires a member to try one or more preferred treatments before another medication is covered, unless an exception applies.

Exceptions

A prescriber or member may request a formulary exception when the standard rule is not clinically appropriate.

Example Formulary

Medication	Tier	Coverage Rule
Atorvastatin	1	No special requirement
Brand-A	2	Preferred brand
Brand-B	3	Prior authorization
Specialty-X	4	Specialty pharmacy + prior authorization